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Culture (OWC): [Bambara \(FA08\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Western Africa

Field Date: No Date

Coverage Date: 1890-1954

Place Coverage: Mali

Section Title(S): 1. The Family

a. In the Paternal Line;

<u>f</u> a = father	<u>d</u> ~ <u>e</u> , <u>de</u> , <u>di</u> = son, daughter
<u>ba</u> , <u>ma</u> , <u>na</u> = wives of the father	<u>d</u> ~ <u>e</u> = son, daughter
<u>binā</u> , <u>baba-ndi</u> ;	<u>d</u> ~ <u>e</u> = son, daughter
<u>benoro</u> + the father's brother; <u>ba</u> - the name = wives of father's brothers	<u>de</u> = son, daughter
<u>ntene</u> ; <u>bingi-musu</u> = father's sister	<u>d</u> ~ <u>e</u> ; <u>bingilingo</u> = son, daughter, nephew, niece.
<u>o</u> or <u>ben-k</u> (<u>a</u>) = husband of father's sister; <u>ben-k</u> (<u>a</u>) is a polite term	the name
<u>k</u> (<u>a</u>) <u>r</u> (<u>a</u>) = older brother, son of father's brother older than speaker	<u>doro</u> = younger brother, son of father's brother younger than speaker
<u>kalame</u> = child of father's sister	<u>kalame</u> = child of mother's brother
<u>mok</u> (<u>a</u>) = father's father	<u>mo-d</u> ~ <u>e</u> , or the name = son's son
<u>mo-muso</u> = father's mother	<u>mo-d</u> ~ <u>e</u> , or the name = son's son

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Ntene = father's sister (term derived from a root ta which has also given tana, tene, interdiction). The maternal aunt is the for-bidden woman of this generation. The same is true for the father's wives and those women they consider as sisters. This relative wields a great influence in the family, and her curse is greatly feared. The children of the ntene-muso are called kalame, and they call the  66 children of their mother's brother kalame. The kalame-w joke and insult each other when they meet. Marriages between them are sometimes permitted, sometimes forbidden.

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